

DAY 11: CUT YOUR WATER BILL

Water bills are one of my least favorite expenses to budget for, mostly because they change so often, but more so because they're super hard to control. The more you use, the more expensive your bill, and it changes based on how long you shower, brush your teeth, wash your hands, or even water your plants! Not to mention that when out of town guests come to visit, your bill can double in a matter of weeks.

We were thrilled to find out that our home in Florida was on a well system, but the city has plans to switch us over to city water some time in the next ten years, and we know we'll have to be more conscious about water usage then. We're hoping it's longer, but until that time comes, it doesn't hurt to practice a few water conserving habits now!

Despite our lucking out down South, we're still not completely exempt from water bills. Our rental back North sends us a pretty hefty statement every quarter in light of the two families that currently live there, making it a painful pill to swallow, and pay, for sure. Especially when we're not the ones controlling usage anymore.

But that's what it really boils down to anyway, right? Using less water. Although we can't predict exactly how much our water bills will be, we can still make a significant impact based on how much we actually use. Sure, you can try to stop water leaks, upgrade to high-efficiency appliances, and even turn crunchy enough to build a rain barrel (which are all good things by the way), but you could still end up with a sky-high water bill simply because you use *too much*.

Smart, daily water habits are where the true savings lie, and these first few steps are where you need to start if you want to get that water bill under control again.

1. BE SMART IN THE SHOWER